

How to Live Before You Die

• Understanding the text

a) What is the story about Steve Jobs' birth?
Ans. Steve Jobs said that his life started with a surprising story. His biological mother was a young college student who felt she could not raise him properly. She wanted him to be adopted by educated parents so he would have a good future. At first, she did not want to give him to his adoptive parents because they were not college graduates, but she later agreed when they promised to send him to college. This story shows how his life began with unexpected decisions that shaped his future.

b) What does he mean when he says, "you can't connect the dots looking forward; you can only connect them looking backwards"?

Ans. He means that when you are going through life, you cannot predict how your experiences will help you later. You cannot see the full picture while the events are happening. But when you look back, you can understand how each experience, even failures, played an important role. Life makes sense only when you look at the past and connect the events. So, he says you must

trust that things will work out and follow your heart, even if the path is not clear at the moment.

c) What happened when Steve Jobs turned 30?

Ans When Steve Jobs turned 30, something unexpected happened - he was fired from Apple, the company he had created. The board decided they no longer wanted him to lead. He felt hurt, lost, and embarrassed. But instead of giving up, he used this failure as a new beginning. He started NeXT and Pixar, two companies that later became very successful. This difficult moment actually helped him grow and become more creative. Years later, Apple bought NeXT, bringing him back to the company stronger than before.

d) Jobs contends that you need to love to do what you do in order to be great at it. Do you agree or disagree? Why?

Ans I agree with his idea because love gives energy and purpose to work. When you enjoy what you do, you naturally put in more time, effort, and care. Even when you face problems or failures, passion helps you stay strong and try again.

people who love their work usually keep improving because they want to do better, not just because they have to. Without love, work feels boring and heavy, and it becomes easy to quit. So loving what you do truly helps you succeed.

Q) Is death really life's greatest invention?
Ans. Steve Jobs believed that death is life's greatest invention because it reminds us that our time is limited. Knowing we will not live forever pushes us to make meaningful choices and follow our dreams. Death also clears the way for new ideas, new people, and new progress. While death is painful and sad, it also gives life value, because it teaches us to appreciate every moment. It encourages us to live honestly and not waste time. In this way, death helps shape the purpose of life.

- Reference to the content

a) Read the extract given below and answer the following questions: ~~that~~

"We have an unexpected baby boy; do you want him?" They said: "Of course."

i) Who was the baby boy?

Ans. The baby boy was Steve Jobs.

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ii) What does 'do you want him?' mean?

Ans. It means the agency was asking the adoptive parents if they would accept and raise the baby, even though his arrival was sudden and not planned.

iii) Who does "they" refer to?

Ans. "They" refers to Steve Jobs' adoptive parents, the couple who agreed to take him in.

b) Explain the following lines?

Ans.

i) "You have to trust in something - your gut, destiny, life, karma, whatever."

Ans. This line means that in life we cannot know everything in advance. Sometimes we must follow our instinct or believe that things will work out. ~~that is~~ Whether we call it destiny, karma, or our inner feeling, we must trust that the choices we make today will help us in the future. It is about having faith in our own path.

ii) "Your time is limited, so don't waste it living someone else's life."

Ans. This means life is short, so we should not spend it trying to please others or follow their expectations. Do not copy someone else's dreams or decisions. In-

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stead, do what you truly want, follow your own goals, and live honestly. You only get one life, so make it your own, not a version controlled by others.

c) What does he mean by "don't settle"?
Ans. Steve Jobs means that people should not stop at something that does not truly satisfy them. Many people choose an easy or comfortable path even when they don't feel happy or fulfilled. Jobs is telling us not to accept a life or career that feels empty just because it seems safe.

He encourages everyone to keep searching until they find something they truly love. Whether it is work, studies, or relationships, passion is important. When you love what you do, you naturally work harder and become better at it.

By saying "don't settle," he is reminding us that real success comes from following our heart. It may take time and patience to find the right path, but it is worth it. Choosing what makes you happy leads to a more meaningful and satisfying life.

Q. Which style of speech is used by the speaker to persuade the audience?

Ans. Steve Jobs uses a semiformal personal storytelling narrative style in his speech. His language is clear and respectful, but not too formal. This makes the audience feel comfortable and connected. He avoids difficult vocabulary and speaks in a natural, human way.

He tells real stories from his own life - about being adopted, dropping out of college, and getting fired from Apple.

These personal stories help the audience understand his message more deeply.

They show that he is not just teaching; he is sharing his true experiences.

This semiformal storytelling style builds trust and keeps the audience interested.

People listen more carefully because the speech feels honest, emotional, and meaningful. It helps him persuade the audience to follow their dreams and believe in themselves.

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c) It is not easy to motivate others. How do you think Steve Jobs' speech is so inspiring?

Ans. Steve Jobs' speech is inspiring because he speaks with honesty and emotion. He talks openly about his failures - being adopted, dropping out of college, getting fired from Apple. When a successful person shares their struggles, people feel hope because they realize that failure is part of success.

He also uses simple but powerful ideas like trusting yourself, following your heart, and living your own life. These ideas are easy to understand but very meaningful. People feel encouraged to think deeply about their own choice.

Finally, Jobs speaks with confidence and belief. He truly means what he says. His calm voice, clear stories, and strong message make the audience feel motivated. He shows that passion and courage can change a life, and this inspires people to improve their own lives.

Q1) Why do you think Steve Jobs used the personal narrative story telling technique in his speech? What influence does it have on the audiences?

Ans. Steve Jobs used personal story because they make the message more real and human. When people hear a story, they feel like they are part of the experience. Jobs wanted the audience to understand that he faced struggles ~~it~~ just like anyone else. Stories create a stronger emotional connection.

His personal stories also help explain big ideas in a simple way. Instead of giving complicated theories, he shows the lessons through his own life. This ~~made~~ makes the message easier to remember and relate to. People understand ideas better when they see how they work in real life.

For the audience, storytelling creates inspiration and trust. It helps listeners believe that success is possible for them too. They feel encouraged to follow their dreams, take risks, and not be afraid of failure. Personal storytelling turns the speech into a powerful and unforgettable experience.

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- Reference beyond the text

a) One of Steve Jobs' motto was: 'Think differently'. Can this make a person succeed in life? What challenges are there in thinking differently?

Ans. Yes, "thinking differently" can help a ~~person~~ person succeed because it allows new ideas, creative solutions, and unique ways of solving problems. It helps people stand out from the crowd. But there are challenges too. Others may not understand or support your ideas. People might criticize or doubt you. Thinking differently also carries risk because new ideas can fail. Still, with confidence and hardwork, it can lead to great success.

b) What does "stay hungry, stay foolish" mean to you?

Ans. To me, "stay hungry, stay foolish" means ^{2.} always be eager to learn more and never feel satisfied with what you already know. "Hungry" means keep your curiosity alive, and "foolish" means don't be afraid to take risks or try new things even if you might fail. It encourages people to remain open-minded, brave, and willing to explore new opportunities throughout life. This motto reminds us that learning,

courage, and trying new paths can lead to great achievement in life.

c) What does it mean to be a visionary? What makes Steve Jobs different from a fortune teller?

Ans. A visionary is someone who can imagine a better future and then works to make that vision real. Visionaries use creativity, intelligence, and hard effort to bring new ideas into the world. Steve Jobs was a visionary because he created technology that changed how people communicate, work and live. A fortune teller only predicts the future without creating anything. Steve Jobs did not guess the future—he built it. His products and ideas shaped real changes, which makes him very different from a fortune teller.